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Moving data into and out of an IR:
Off the map and into the territory

Libby Bishop
University of Leeds/University of Essex
IASSIST Conference
Stanford, 28 May 2008

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Institutional and domain repositories, researchers and the research life cycle

(Green and Gutmann, 2007)

- Cooperation and specialisation among
  - Institutional repositories - close to PIs
  - Domain repositories - data mgt & preservation
  - Researchers - content expertise

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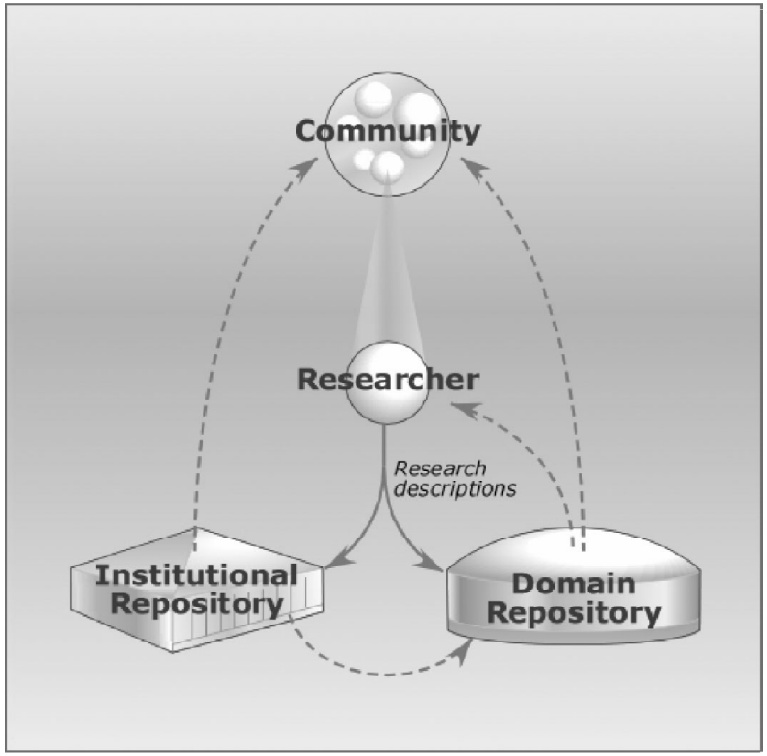

Note: Research Descriptions are passed from Researcher to Repositories and on to the Research Community

Green and Gutmann, 2007

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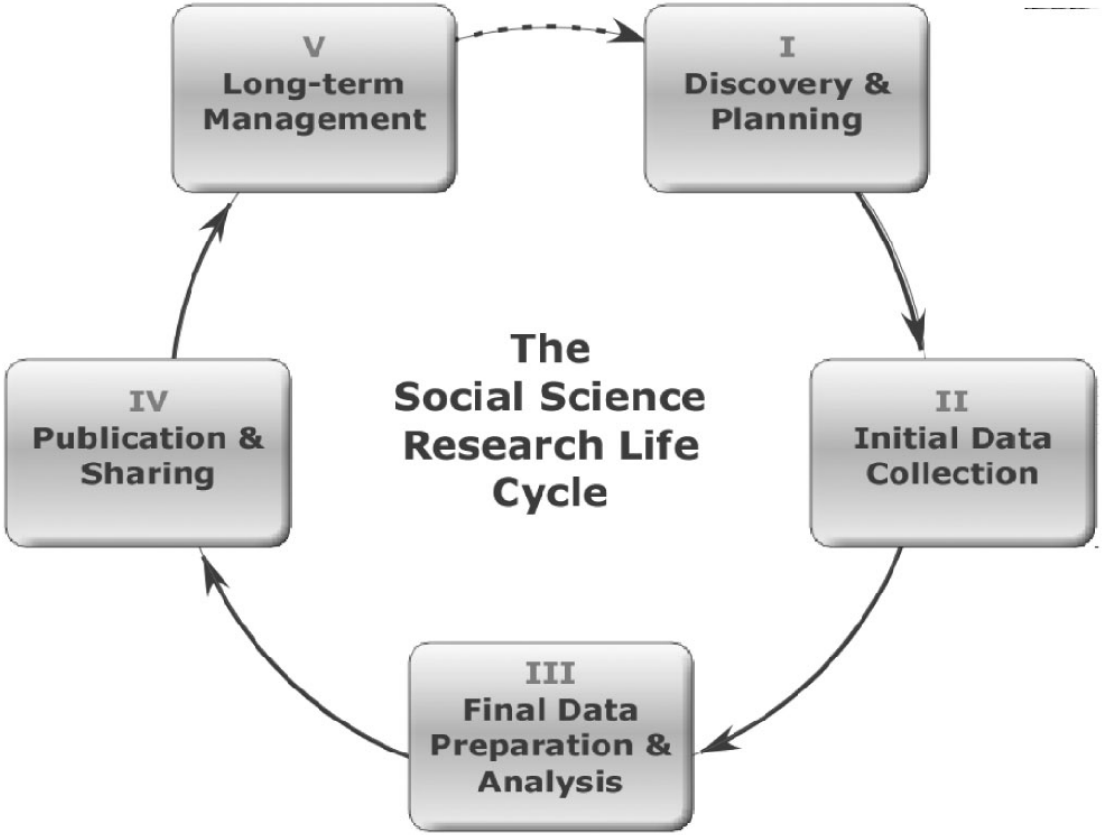

Green and Gutmann, 2007

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http://www.timescapes.leeds.ac.uk/

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Timescapes
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Events

Exhibiting the 'Young Lives and Times' project
15/03/08

Interpreting Lives through Time
30/03/08

View all events

ARCHIVE

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The 'Timescapes' study is the first major Qualitative Longitudinal Study to be funded in the UK. The five year programme, which commenced in February 2007, is exploring the ways in which personal and family relationships unfold over time and over the life course, and how those relationships shape who we are. The focus is on relationships with significant others: parents, grandparents, siblings, children, partners, friends and lovers.

Funded under the ESRC 'Changing Lives and Times Qualitative Longitudinal Initiative' the study uses a method of 'walking alongside' people to document the processes of growing up, forming and transforming relationships, bearing and rearing children, living in families and growing older. The study will explore how these processes impact on people's life chances and well being and what this means for intergenerational support and the long term resourcing of families.

The research is creating a wealth of ethnographic data - in depth interviews, oral narratives, photographs and other visual documents - that is being gathered together to form the Timescapes Archive at the University of Leeds. This specialist resource is being created for re-use among current and future generations of researchers and will be preserved for posterity. The Archive will expand and be enriched through the addition of affiliated projects and will offer exciting possibilities for re-searching data through time and across the generations.

Timescapes Memoryshare Update

An exciting partnership between Timescapes and the BBC. More details to follow soon.

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Timescapes is about…

Doing Research:

- Personal relationships, intimacy and family life
- ≈£5 million, 5 years, 7 projects, 5 universities

Building a data archive:

- 400+ participants, 5+ years, multiple interactions
- 5000+ objects with large margin of error
- 500+ GB with an even larger margin of error

Sharing data

- Within the team, with affiliates and beyond

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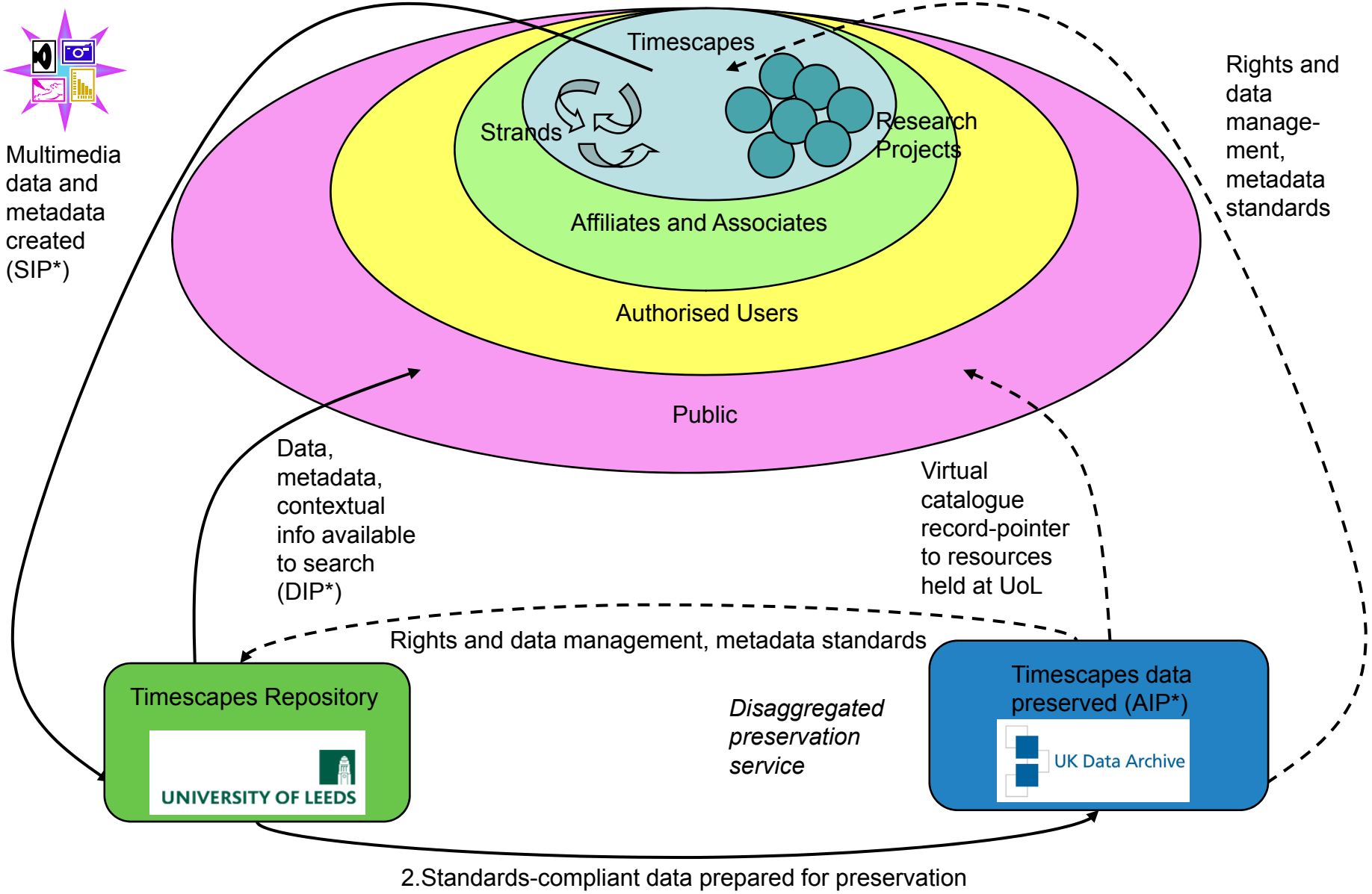
Information and Data Flows among Researchers, the Timescapes Repository, and the UK Data Archive



Data producers and users

Data users

Data

Information

*SIP-Submission Information Package
*AIP-Archival Information Package
*DIP-Dissemination Information Package

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Distinctive features of Timescapes

- Characteristics of the materials deposited
  - Data and documentation, not just outputs
  - Qualitative, including image, audio, video
  - Sensitive content, complex rights management
  - Longitudinal, dynamic
- Characteristics of the research process
  - Emergent, interpretive, and especially ***iterative***
  - Synchronous research, archive building and sharing

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Getting data in: informed consent

- Real risks: personal, geo-spatial, longit, formats
- The case for written consent (UKDA)
  - DPA requirement for processing personal information
  - Advised for ease of negotiation Review Ethics Ctes
- The case for verbal consent, later (researchers)
  - Some participants put off by formality of written consent
  - Consent will be more “informed” after data are produced
  - Trust will increase over time, more likely to get consent
  - No hurry to seek consent now because of long timeframe

Slow, <100% standardised, time-consuming

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Getting metadata in: who's got the standard?

"…the domain-specific repository has specialized knowledge of data management approaches to data in a specific scientific field, for example, domain-specific metadata standards (the DDI in the case of the social sciences), as well as the ability to expose the research products to the field in a way that will have the greatest impact (Green and Gutmann, 2007)".

- Qualitative data needs a lot of metadata
  - Diverse file formats; types within formats; context
- Relevant metadata knowledge is distributed
  - Resource discovery; technical, admin; preservation

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Getting metadata in: challenges

- Existing UKDA standards: DDI, DC, OAI-PMH
- Emerging UKDA standards: TEI, PREMIS, METS, audio/video
- Need to specify descriptive metadata for RD before data analysis complete (or started).
- Testing limits of DigiTool s/w (single entry form)
- Untested quality of researcher-provided metadata

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DigiTool - Deposit
DIGITAL ASSET MANAGEMENT

User: Libby Bishop **Admin Unit:** [LUD01] leeds university repository

1 2 3 4 5

Descriptive Information

Programme Name: Timescapes

* Study Name: P4. Masculinities, Fatherhood and Risk
  - P4. Masculinities, Fatherhood and Risk
  - P5. Work and Family Lives.
  - S1. Archiving

* Interviewer:

* Interviewee ID: P7.3

Date of interview: 11/15/2000

Date of birth of interviewee:

Gender: ○ Female ◉ Male

Next > Cancel

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DigiTool - Deposit - Microsoft Internet Explorer

File Edit View Favorites Tools Help

Address http://ludos.leeds.ac.uk:1801/deposit/action/workflow.do

DigiTool - Deposit
DIGITAL ASSET MANAGEMENT

User: RYANB Admin Unit: [TSC01] Timescapes

Descriptive Information

* PROJECTNO
* CASEID
* DOBM
* DOBY
* GENDER
- Male
- Female

* MARSTATUS
- Married
- Separated
- Divorced
- Widowed
- Have never been married
- In a civil partnership
- Have a dissolved civil partnership
- Separated from a civil partnership
- Surviving partner of civil partnership

* LFSTATUS
- Self employed
- In paid employment
- Unemployed
- Retired from paid work altogether
- On maternity leave
- Looking after famuily or hoem
- Full-time student/at school
- Long term sick or disabled
- On a government training scheme
- Something else

LFSTATUSTXT
HRSWORK
CURRJOB
EVRHADJOB
- Yes
- No

LASTJOB
* PTNRWORK
- Yes
- No

PTNRJOB
AGELEFT
ANYQUAL
- Yes
- No

- Degree or above
- A levels or equivalent

Done Trusted sites

Start Inbox - Microsoft Outlook DigiTool - Deposit - Mi... 11:07

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Getting data out: access and preservation

- Preservation
  - LUDOS will ingest SIPs, disseminate DIPs
  - UKDA will produce AIPs and DIPs
  - But UKDA DIPs will be less frequent
  - Need to define versions clearly
- Access
  - UKDA metadata for resource discovery is at the collection level
  - Timescapes will require item level metadata for access control of dissemination

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Conclusions

- Timescapes territory is inhabited by dragons
  - Cooperation takes time and lots of it
  - Entities have their own, unsynchronised, timetables
  - Timing of hand-offs, triggers and cooperation can be tricky
- Green and Gutmann map is the right destination
  - Need better metadata to lower ingest costs (42% for acquisition and ingest, JISC report, *Keeping Research Data Safe)*
  - Need institutional collaborations for efficient division of labour and long-term sustainability

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